

Cybercrime Type: UPI/Online Payment Fraud

Description: UPI fraud is a type of cybercrime where attackers trick victims into authorizing a payment through a UPI app (like GPay, PhonePe, or Paytm).

Step-by-Step Scenario:

1. **The Hook:** The attacker finds a victim on a marketplace (like OLX) or social media. They pose as a buyer or someone offering a "cashback reward."
2. **The Bait:** The attacker sends a "Request Money" link or a QR code to the victim, claiming it is to *receive* money.
3. **The Trap:** The victim is told to scan the QR code and "Enter UPI PIN" to receive the amount.
4. **The Consequence:** Once the PIN is entered, the amount is actually *debited* (deducted) from the victim's account instead of being credited.

Target Audience: Usually college students, small sellers, or elderly people who are new to digital payments.

Consequences: Immediate financial loss, potential identity theft if the app is compromised, and severe mental stress for the victim.